

“In small matters
[foreigners]
oppress ...
people; in large
matters they
**insult what
is divine.**”

EMPERESS DOWAGER CIXI, IN SUPPORT OF THE BOXER UPRISINGS, 1900

THE BOXER REBELLION

Empress Dowager Cixi was the de facto ruler of China's Manchu Qing Dynasty from 1861–1908. In 1899, she gave her support to the Boxer rebels, who wanted to rid China of Western influence. Much of their hatred of foreigners was directed at Western missionaries and Chinese converts to Christianity, whom they saw as betraying their culture. In June 1900, over 100,000 people—mainly Chinese Christians, but also 200 foreigners—were murdered at the empress's command. Although the Boxer rebellion ultimately failed, Cixi continued to rule until her death in 1908.

